

Curriculum Vitae: Preston Walker

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Education

Rutgers University:

Doctorate of Mathematics (w/ Advisor: Dr. Alex Kontorovich);

Overall/Mathematics GPA: 3.900; Expected Graduation Spring 2028

More information about the mathematics doctoral program at Rutgers University can be found here:

<https://math.rutgers.edu/academics/graduate-program>

Texas A&M University:

Bachelor of Science in Mathematics,

Master of Science in Mathematics (w/ Advisor: Dr. Matthew Young);

Overall GPA: 3.933[†]; Mathematics GPA: 3.922[†]; Graduated Spring 2024

Finished a 3+2 Bachelors & Masters of Science program in Mathematics at Texas A&M University. This was done through the university's FastTrack program, more information can be found here:

<https://math.tamu.edu/graduate/fasttrack/>.

Employment

National Science Foundation:

Graduate Research Fellow; August 2024 - May 2029

Employed as a graduate research fellow as per the National Science Foundation's Graduate Research Fellowship.

Rutgers University:

Graduate Fellow; August 2024 - May 2027

Employed as a fellow by the Rutgers University math department while under full financial support from the National Science Foundation's Graduate Research Fellowship.

Texas A&M University:

Graduate Student Researcher; May 2023 - May 2024

Helped with a variety of research projects in the Texas A&M University mathematics department and beyond. See the below *Research Experience* section for more details.

Student Grader; August 2021 - December 2021, January 2023 - May 2024

Assisted professors by grading papers and providing feedback for hundreds of students across various courses including linear algebra, differential equations, and communications and cryptography (MATH 304, 308, and 470 respectively).

Assistant Student Editor; January 2022 - May 2024

Assisted a professor in editing practice problems for a fully online calculus textbook and developing fully interactive Geogebra applets to quiz students on their calculus knowledge.

Undergraduate Student Researcher; August 2021 - May 2023

Helped with a variety of research projects in the Texas A&M University mathematics department and beyond. See the below *Research Experience* section for more details.

Data Science Intern; May 2020 - April 2022

Created a novel computer application for the Texas A&M geography department which analyses large amounts of photo metadata and streamlines various common methodologies of repeat photography.

*Contains more detailed information on many of the sections within this document.

[†]Combined undergraduate and graduate GPA including hours not counted towards my degree.

Research Experience

Rutgers University:

Advisor: *Dr. Alex Kontorovich*; January 2026 - Present;

Topic: *Local-to-Global Principles for Co-compact Circle Packings*

Building upon the work of Bourgain and Kontorovich to prove a local-to-global result for circle packings with co-compact fundamental domains. This research will become my thesis.

Advisor: *Dr. Alex Kontorovich*; January 2025 - Present;

Topic: *Strong Prime Number Theorem in LEAN*

Leading the effort to prove the strong prime number theorem in the LEAN theorem prover with Mathlib quality code.

Texas A&M University:

Advisor: *Dr. Matthew Young*; August 2022 - August 2024;

Topic: *Higher Weight Generalized Dedekind Sums*

As a follow up project to the summer 2022 REU at Texas A&M University, this research project generalizes the concept of Dedekind sums by examining period integrals of higher weight holomorphic Eisenstein series attached to characters. We also demonstrate quantum modularity, and many arithmetic and analytic properties.

Advisors: *Dr. Philip Yasskin, Dr. Wei Yan*; January 2022 - August 2024;

Topic: *Teaching Rotations Through Augmented Reality*

This research project examines the ability for augmented reality to serve as a supplemental instruction method to further develop student's geometric intuition on rotations in three dimensional space.

Advisor: *Dr. Matthew Young*; May 2022 - July 2022;

Topic: *REU in Number Theory, Fast Computation of Generalized Dedekind Sums*

Developed the first polynomial time algorithm to compute generalized Dedekind sums by utilizing a well engineered group rewriting process. This represents a significant improvement over previous exponential time algorithms.

Publications/Formalizations

Journal Articles:

Higher Weight Generalized Dedekind Sums; Published 3/31/2026 to *Journal of Number Theory*

Publication due to self-guided research under the supervision of Dr. Matthew Young while at Texas A&M University.

It is available here:

<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jnt.2026.02.001>.

AR-Classroom: Integrating Conversational Artificial Intelligence with Augmented Reality Technology for Learning Spatial Transformations and Their Matrix Representation (with U. Monjoree, S. D. Aguilar, et al.); Published 10/13/2024 to *2024 IEEE Frontiers in Education Conference*

Publication due to the research on teaching rotations through augmented Reality. It is available here:

<https://doi.org/10.1109/FIE61694.2024.10893308>.

Fast Computation of Generalized Dedekind Sums (with J. Wang);

Published 3/20/2024 to *International Journal of Number Theory*

Publication due to the research produced during the summer 2022 REU at Texas A&M University. It is available here:

<https://doi.org/10.1142/S179304212450060X>.

Formalizations:

Prime Number Theorem and... (with A. Kontorovich, T. Tao, et al.)

Formalization due to my involvement in the ongoing effort to formalize the strong prime number theorem (with the traditional $O(x \exp(-c\sqrt{\log x}))$ error term) in LEAN. It is available here:

<https://github.com/AlexKontorovich/PrimeNumberTheoremAnd>.

Conferences, Workshops, and Presentations

14. *Arizona Winter School 2026 (Attendee)*; 3/7-11/2026
13. *Joint Mathematics Meetings 2026 (Attendee)*; 1/4-7/2026
12. *MPS Workshop on LEAN (Attendee)*; 6/16-27/2025
11. *Joint Mathematics Meetings 2024 (Presenter)*; 1/3-6/2024
10. *Texas A&M Undergraduate Mathematics Research Expo (Presenter)*; 9/26/2023
9. *MAA MathFest 2023 (Presenter)*; 8/2-5/2023
8. *Texas Undergraduate Groups and Dynamics Conference (Presenter)*; 3/31-4/1/2023
7. *TX-LA Undergraduate Mathematics Conference (Presenter)*; 3/25-26/2023
6. *Southern Regional Number Theory Conference (Attendee)*; 3/11-12/2023
5. *Joint Mathematics Meetings 2023 (Presenter)*; 1/4-7/2023
4. *Texas Undergraduate Mathematics Conference (Presenter)*; 10/28-29/2022
3. *Texas A&M Undergraduate Mathematics Research Expo (Presenter)*; 10/20/2022
2. *Young Mathematicians Conference (Presenter)*; 8/12-14/2022
1. *LAUNCH Undergraduate Research Summer Poster Session (Presenter)*; 8/3/2022

Service

Ongoing Service

Seminar Organizer; August 2025 - Present

Organized a variety of seminars within the Rutgers University mathematics department to enrich my peer's education.

Office Manager; May 2025 - Present

Oversees the large administrative undertaking of assigning the offices for every student in the mathematics department.

Rutgers University Directed Reading Program (Instructor); August 2024 - Present

Directed advanced students through a reading course on various topics in mathematics.

Rutgers University Math Department Welcoming Committee; August 2024 - Present

Organized events for prospective students touring the Rutgers University mathematics department.

Previous Service

Texas A&M University Math Club (Vice President); August 2022 - May 2024

Helped organize biweekly math club meetings and also developed the club's biweekly math problem solving competition as an outreach activity for undergraduates interested in higher mathematics.

Texas A&M University Math Circle (Facilitator/Instructor); August 2021 - May 2024

The Texas A&M University Math Circle is an organization which seeks to help students grades 5-12 gain exposure to interesting topics which otherwise may not be presented in regular coursework. Assisting in both the facilitation and instruction of the learning environment created by the Texas A&M University Math Circle.

Awards/Distinctions

Member of the American Mathematical Society; August 2024 - Present

National Science Foundation Graduate Research Fellow; August 2024 - May 2029

The National Science Foundation's Graduate Research Fellowship provides an estimated \$200,000 total in tuition waivers and stipend funding towards my PhD. More information can be found here: <https://nsfgrfp.org/>

Rutgers University Presidential Fellowship; August 2024 - May 2027

The Rutgers University Presidential Fellowship provides an estimated \$30,000 in supplementary funding towards my PhD. More information can be found here:

<https://grad.rutgers.edu/funding/fellowships-grants/presidential-fellowships>

Mary and Robert N. Walker Endowed Scholarship; August 2021 - May 2024

This scholarship is awarded to a freshman mathematics major by the Texas A&M University mathematics department. More information can be found here: <https://math.tamu.edu/undergraduate/scholarships/>.